Ethical Storytelling, Photography and Media Consent Policy

This policy sets out how GPAK collects and uses photographs, video, voice recordings and written stories involving participants and their children, across all of GPAK's programmes.

1 Principles

- Her story belongs to her. A participant decides whether, how and for how long her image or story is used.
- Dignity comes first: no image or story that could embarrass, expose or endanger a participant is used, whatever the audience.
- No image or story reveals a participant's HIV status, a minor's pregnancy status, her specific location or the school she attends.
- No image shows a participant or child in distress.
- Pseudonyms are used by default. A real first name is used only with the separate consent described in section 2.
- No HIV-related story is linked to any identifiable image of the person it describes.

2 Consent process

Consent for a photograph, video, voice recording or story is separate from consent to join a programme. It is explained to the participant in her own language, in plain terms, before anything is recorded or used. She may say no without any effect on the support she receives. She may withdraw her consent at any time, and GPAK will stop further use of the material from the point it is told, though material already shared outside GPAK's control (for example printed materials already distributed) may not be fully recoverable.

3 Under-18 rules

For a participant under 18, GPAK uses an identifiable image or story only where both her caregiver gives written consent and she gives her own assent. Where a caregiver cannot be safely involved, or either the caregiver or the participant does not agree, GPAK does not use any identifiable image or story of her: it may still describe her situation in general terms, without any identifying detail.

4 Approval before publishing

No photograph, video or story involving a participant is published, in any format, until the Director has checked it against this policy and signed it off. This includes material for the GPAK website, social media, donor reports and funder-specific materials.

5 Visitors and donors

A visitor or donor, including a funder's representatives, may photograph or record during a visit only in line with the Visitor Briefing and Confidentiality Undertaking (DD-02) and with the same separate consent described in section 2. A visitor never photographs a participant without GPAK staff present and without that consent having been obtained first.

6 Storage and retention

Consented images and recordings are stored in GPAK's own systems, access limited to staff who need them for the approved use. They are kept only for as long as the consented use continues, reviewed annually, and deleted

when a participant withdraws consent or when they are no longer needed for the approved purpose, whichever is sooner.

Approval and review

Item	Detail
Policy owner	Director
Approved by	Advisory Committee
Applies to	All GPAK staff, Advisory Committee members, volunteers, mentor mothers, community volunteers, interns, consultants, contractors and partners working on GPAK activities
Review	Every two years, or earlier if the law, a funder requirement or an incident review shows that a change is needed.

Public copy. Internal forms, annexes and signature pages are kept on file by GPAK and are available on request.